

Agentic Commerce Is Here

Agent payments and real world AI workflows

THE OPENING TEST

When payment succeeds but the result fails

I asked an agent to pay a storage service to store this photograph and return it unchanged. Some downloads were wrong.



ORIGINAL

66 bytes

The payment succeeded. The returned file did not.

TEMPO OBJECT STORAGE

Returned artifact

REQUEST	Paid download
SIZE	66 bytes
TYPE	ASCII text
EXPECTED	JPEG

VERIFICATION FAILED

Where I have shown this work

Amazon

A generative AI application that listened to patient symptoms and helped triage the case.

Tencent

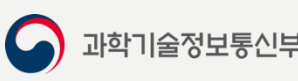
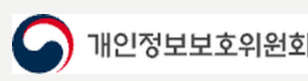
An AI workflow that created and edited video and audio across media services.

Stripe

Agents that sent and received payments inside real workflows.

Agentic commerce is already taking shape

ECOSYSTEM · SOUTH KOREA

Models + assistants	       
AI native	       
Enterprise	      
Payments + commerce	      
AI chips + infra	    
Public + trust	       

Agents are already inside enterprise systems here

Douzone

Commercially deployed AI assisted ERP and tax workflows, with records, evidence, tax treatment and human approval in scope.

Emro

In one customer deployment, procurement agents find similar orders and compare quotations before an order exists.

Samsung SDS

Enterprise AI Agent and Brity Automation work alongside the Caidentia procurement platform under existing controls.

Agents have begun to make payments too

Kakao Pay exposes approval, status, cancellation and subscription functions through its MCP server and agent toolkit.

Mastercard has reported one completed authenticated agentic transaction here, with named partners.

FINANCIAL SERVICES COMMISSION

Revised financial AI guidance emphasizes human supervision, defined responsibility, consumer protection, security and early risk management.

It points toward staged test operations in controlled settings once preparatory work is complete.

Four practical questions for your organization

01 What can the agent read?

02 What can it change?

03 What can it pay?

04 How will you check the result?

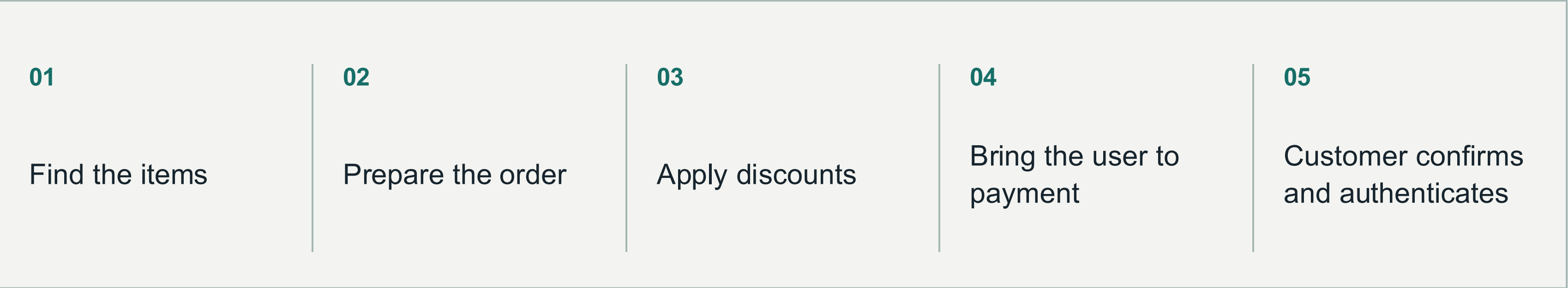
ECOSYSTEM · GLOBAL

Agent experiences	OpenAI Google Microsoft perplexity amazon Cognition
Enterprise	salesforce servicenow SAP workday ORACLE IBM UiPath ATlassian
Build + observe	LangChain openai LlamaIndex NVIDIA arize DATADOG Vercel
Foundation models	ANTHROPIC Meta Mistral cohere deepseek
Payments + commerce	mastercard VISA stripe PayPal adyen AMERICAN EXPRESS coinbase CIRCLE shopify
Identity + security	okta SailPoint paloalto NETWORKS Akamai NIST National Institute of Standards and Technology U.S. Department of Commerce OWASP fido ALLIANCE
China + SEA	Alibaba Baidu 百度 Tencent Z.AI Grab AI SINGAPORE Ant International
Protocols + standards	MCP · A2A · UCP · AP2 · ACP · ISO/IEC 42001

Two checkout models are emerging globally

Agent orchestrated checkout

Alibaba's Qwen connects a conversation to Taobao Instant Commerce and Alipay AI Pay. The agent stays with the task through payment confirmation.



The scale it already operates at

4B+

products connected across Taobao and Tmall, covering discovery, comparison, ordering, logistics and after sales

140M

users had tried Qwen's AI shopping functions by the end of February

300M

AI Pay transactions recorded across Alipay's wider platform

Discovery in chat, checkout at the merchant

Shopee in ChatGPT

Available across Southeast Asia, Taiwan and Brazil. Customers discover products in conversation, then continue to Shopee to complete the purchase.

Shopify stores in ChatGPT

For US users, products appear in ChatGPT shopping results, then checkout moves to the merchant's storefront. The merchant retains payment, fulfillment, returns and the customer relationship.

In both models, the commerce platform remains the system of record.

The difference is where the handoff happens

	AGENT ORCHESTRATED	CHAT DISCOVERY
Discovery	In conversation	In conversation
Order preparation	Agent prepares and applies discounts	Handed to the merchant
Payment	Customer confirms in flow	Merchant controlled checkout
System of record	The commerce platform	The commerce platform

Beneath checkout: the payment stack

Four layers behind agent payments

01 Authority

Alipay AI Pay, Mastercard Agent Pay and Visa Intelligent Commerce connect customer approval to a limited payment credential and transaction record.

02 Wallet

Stripe Link issues a single use credential after approval. Cloudflare delegates wallets with spending limits. Coinbase Agentic Wallet holds stablecoins with per payment and per session limits.

03 Payment and settlement

x402 and MPP state a service's price inside a request. The agent pays, receives the result and gets a receipt. MPP can settle on Tempo; x402 through networks such as Base.

04 Service discovery

MPP Services and Coinbase's x402 Bazaar let agents find paid APIs. The catalog narrows the choice; the live request confirms price and terms.

How skills, MCP and plugins fit together

TEACH

Skills

Teach the agent how to complete a task with procedures, reference material and checks.

CONNECT

MCP servers

Connect the agent to live tools and data in other systems.

PACKAGE

Agent Plugins 1.0

Package skills and MCP configurations in a portable bundle.

AWS Agent Toolkit, Azure Skills Plugin and Cloudflare's plugin combine guidance with MCP tools. Google Workspace preview servers connect agents to Gmail, Drive, Docs, Sheets, Calendar and Chat.

From provisioning to procurement

TODAY

Provisioning

The agent can create an AWS resource, deploy to Azure, or manage Cloudflare or Vercel. The provider and billing relationship are already set.



EMERGING

Procurement

The agent encounters an external service, receives a price and pays within its delegated budget.

Bedrock AgentCore Payments	In preview
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Doma	Domains
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Locus	Hosted apps and databases
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Six workflows, six engineering techniques

Stop at a reviewable output

Do not ask how much the agent can automate. Ask whether your team can tell if the work is right. If not, narrow the task.

Reviewability controls what an agent may produce.
Spending limits control how far it may go.

Finance	An exception list
Receivables	A draft reminder
Trademark matter	A consultation pack

Set one budget for the whole task

In my test, storing the file, retrieving it and some retries were separate paid actions. Each payment was small, but the total kept growing.

01 One budget covers the whole task, including retries and checks.

02 At the limit, the agent stops and asks.

03 If the seller, price or order changes, ask for approval again.

04 Measure what the task cost and whether the right result was delivered.

Four failures to test before production

- | | | |
|----|-------------------------|---|
| 01 | Uncertain payment | Check the payment status before retrying. If you cannot confirm the outcome, stop and send it for review. |
| 02 | Changed terms | If the price, currency, quantity or delivery terms change, ask for approval again. |
| 03 | Wrong or missing result | Ask the seller to correct it. If that fails, cancel or request a refund. Leave any unresolved dispute for human review. |
| 04 | Unavailable provider | Use another provider only if it is approved and the task stays within budget. Otherwise, ask before changing the seller, account or payment method. |

Stop one failure from becoming a second payment, a changed purchase or an unapproved action.

Business opportunities: structured handoffs

A CrewAI multi agent workflow researched and qualified US business opportunities, then prepared sales collateral from a market brief.

THE TECHNIQUE

A structured handoff kept company evidence and match reason with each opportunity record used for collateral.

THE OUTPUT

One reviewable package: evidence, match reason and draft collateral.

Business intelligence: governed data access

An AI agent connected a Lovable interface to governed BigQuery data. Starting with a business question and defined metrics, it explored the data, explained findings and prepared a dashboard.

THE TECHNIQUE

Governed access limited the agent to approved BigQuery data and defined metrics, keeping findings traceable into the dashboard.

THE OUTPUT

The result and missing information, ready for a person to decide whether to act.

Finance and receivables: review exceptions first

The workflow used ledger exports, service logs, foreign exchange rates and supporting documents to reconcile records, expose evidence gaps, propose adjustments and prepare Xero based reminder drafts.

THE TECHNIQUE

Match the records that agree, show the records that do not, and keep the source beside each difference.

THE OUTPUT

Financial reports, source linked exception lists and draft payment reminders.

Content delivery: staged tool orchestration

The workflows generated video and audio, assembled clips, converted formats and returned output through Telegram. They also produced a scheduled news summary and dated Singapore visitor guide.

THE TECHNIQUE

Staged tool orchestration checked each output before moving to the next service.

THE OUTPUT

A media package, scheduled summary or visitor guide, delivered through the requested channel and checked on arrival.

Clinical and legal work: grounded case preparation

Voice AI collected symptoms for a structured P1 to P4 triage summary. The legal workflow organized documents, dates, classes, deadlines and prior use into a case pack.

THE TECHNIQUE

Grounded case preparation collected required fields, linked statements to sources and exposed missing evidence in the handoff.

THE OUTPUT

Organized evidence with gaps exposed. The clinician or lawyer made the decision.

Agent QA: evaluation driven development

A QA suite covered 174 cases across quotations, orders, invoices, payments, calendars and business rules. It classified every result and ran after every change.

THE TECHNIQUE

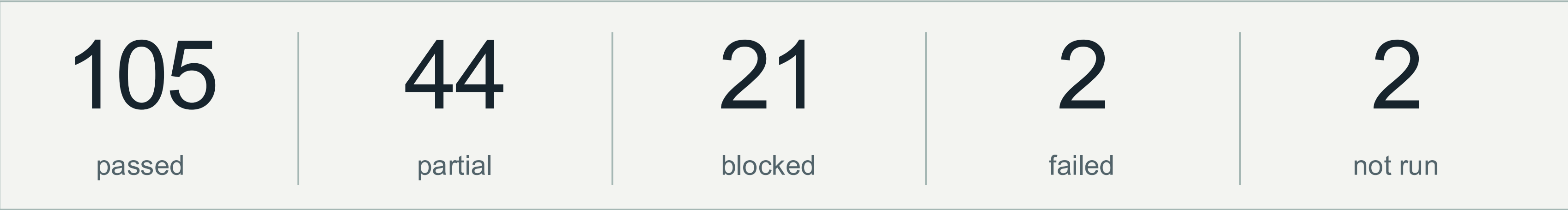
Evaluation driven development tested repeatable cases instead of relying on a few successful demonstrations.

THE OUTPUT

A repeatable regression suite showing greater reliability and lower operating cost.

AFTER ONE AUTONOMOUS CORRECTION CYCLE

174 cases, classified



Compression and caching then cut token use by 50 percent.

The payment succeeded, but the workflow had not.

- | | | |
|----|----------|--|
| 01 | Goal | Store and return one photograph unchanged. |
| 02 | Payment | The payment succeeded. |
| 03 | Result | Some returned files were wrong. |
| 04 | Recovery | Verified after six paths and multiple paid transactions. |

Six paths. Multiple real paid transactions. One verified outcome.



RETURNED FILE

Four questions to answer before deploying

01 What counts as complete?

02 When must the agent stop?

03 Which decisions must remain with a person?

04 How will the workflow recover when the result is wrong?

If you can answer those, you have a workflow you can test.

An agent is ready to transact when it can complete the work, prove the result, and stop when it should.

Scan to connect or view the slides.



LINKEDIN



SLIDES